

Use Case: SAP Inventory Management

Use Case Name: Automate Purchase Order Generation

Step 1: Questions for your client

1. *Could you walk me through your current process for managing reagent inventory?*
2. *What specific data points are you recording in your Microsoft Access database versus what you write down on paper?*
3. *Can you describe a recent "failed experiment" caused by inventory issues—was it due to an expired reagent or a stockout?*
4. *How do you currently identify which reagents are nearing their expiration date?*
5. *When a reagent is delivered, how do you decide where to store it and how is that location recorded?*
6. *What is the biggest challenge you face when trying to reorder materials?*
7. *How do you determine the "minimum stock level" for a specific reagent before you know it's time to reorder?*
8. *Could you explain the approval process required before a purchase order can be sent to a vendor?*
9. *When you are on leave, what are the most common mistakes your colleagues make when trying to use your current system?*
10. *Are there specific safety regulations or "hazardous material" classifications we need to track for certain chemicals?*
11. *What kind of weekly or monthly reports would help you justify laboratory spending to your supervisors?*
12. *How would you like the system to alert you—via email, a dashboard notification, or a mobile alert?*
13. *Are there specific vendors you must use, or do you have the flexibility to shop around for better prices?*
14. *Does your lab have existing barcodes on reagents, or would you like the new SAP system to generate them for you?*
15. *If you could change one thing about the way you currently find a "missing" vial, what would it be?*

Step 3: Have ChatGPT to transcribe and analyze the interview

This summary is generated based on the persona of Garima, the lab technician.

Summary Report: Reagent Management System Requirements

The interview with Garima revealed a high-stress environment stemming from a fragmented inventory process. Currently, the lab relies on a mix of paper logs and an outdated Access database, leading to significant data silos. The primary **pain points** are "invisible" expiration dates and the lack of a standardized location naming convention, which causes experiment failures and safety risks.

Prioritized Requirements:

- **Centralized Real-Time Tracking:** A single SAP-based "Source of Truth" to replace paper and Access.
- **Automated Alerts:** Low-stock notifications and "Days until Expiration" triggers.
- **Simplified UI:** A user-friendly interface that allows non-expert colleagues to log usage and reorder without intensive training.
- **Reporting:** Automated generation of stock levels and consumption patterns.

Open Questions: We still need to clarify the specific SAP module integration (e.g., SAP MM or a simplified S/4HANA Fiori app) and whether existing lab hardware (barcode scanners) is compatible with the proposed digital solution.

Step 4: Summarize the key findings and insights from the interview

Key Findings & Insights	• Manual Inefficiency: Heavy reliance on manual entry in Microsoft Access leads to frequent human error and outdated stock levels. • Knowledge Silos: The current system is so complex that work stops when Garima is on vacation, creating a single point of failure.
Desired Features & Functionality	• Visual Expiration Tracking: A dashboard that highlights reagents nearing their end-of-life. • Automated Reordering: The system should trigger a Purchase Order request when stock hits a pre-defined threshold. • Location Mapping: A digital "map" or locator to find specific vials across various shelves and tubes.
Constraints & Requirements	• User Experience: The tool must be simple enough for all lab staff to use with minimal training to ensure data integrity during Garima's absence. • SAP Compatibility: The solution must fit within a "simple version" of SAP, focusing on core Inventory Management (IM) functions.
Next Steps	• System Demo: Schedule a walkthrough of a simplified SAP Fiori interface for Garima to test usability. • Data Migration: Begin auditing the current Access database to prepare for cleaning and uploading data into SAP.